



SILICON TO STEERING WHEEL

How Qualcomm's first Snapdragon Auto Day mapped India's smart mobility future

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It's not often that a single event brings together the big three of mobility's future: cutting-edge technology, national policy, and on-the-ground behavioural change. But that's exactly what unfolded in New Delhi when Qualcomm hosted its first-ever Snapdragon Auto Day in partnership with Times Network.

For a company that's been synonymous with smartphone chips for decades, Qualcomm's message was unambiguous: the automotive sector isn't just another market for them, it's the next frontier, and India is central to that vision.

India: From market to innovation engine

"India is the place to be, and hopefully you can see that in the energy, the

partnerships, and really the innovation that's happening across the board," said Savi Soin, President of Qualcomm India, opening the event with a keynote that felt part vision statement, part rallying cry.

Soin pointed out something most people outside the industry don't realise: Qualcomm has more engineers in India than anywhere else in the world. And these aren't just back-office coders; they're shaping the future of in-cabin AI, driver assistance systems, and connected vehicle platforms from the ground up.

From Tata Motors' premium EVs to Maruti Suzuki's mass-market models, Qualcomm's automotive platforms already power a range of Indian vehicles. Features like multi-screen infotainment, facial recognition, zonal audio, and driver monitoring systems

are becoming more accessible, and crucially, they're being tuned for Indian road conditions and cultural nuances.

Beyond four wheels: The two-wheeler imperative

If you want to solve road safety in India, you can't ignore two-wheelers, which make up the majority of the country's vehicle fleet. Qualcomm's pitch included connectivity and safety features for motorcycles and scooters: 4G/5G and Bluetooth, GPS navigation, theft alerts, SOS assistance, and even notifications for the nearest charging stations for EV riders.

Imagine a rider getting an automatic SOS alert to family and authorities after a crash, or receiving live route updates when a road is flooded: tech that saves lives.

Policy meets innovation: A vision for safer roads

Qualcomm brought the silicon, Union Road Transport and Highways Minister Nitin Gadkari brought the reality: India's roads are dangerous, and fixing them is more than better chips.